

OE3C Planning Meeting 4

Date: 01 Dec 2025

Location: CRN 527/Online

Time: 10:05 – 11:14 AM

Attendees: Lyllian Corbin, Alex Wilder, Kiyoko Gotanda, Reem Mahamoud, Rasa Khosrowshahli, Sarah Hein, Nicholas Benton, Matthew Summervillei, Madelaine Legault, Cassia Hamilton, Wylan Clitheroe

Chairs: Kiyoko Gotanda, Alex Wilder

Minutes by: Lyllian Corbin

Alex began the meeting at 10:05 AM.

Call to Order and Approval of Minutes

- Alex moved to approve the meeting minutes from 27 Nov 2025
 - Meeting agenda was approved

Meeting with Dean Berg (recap with Alex and Lyllian)

- Lyllian and Alex spoke to FMS Dean about the OE3C planning
 - Alex explained our efforts to apply for the Exchange Grant, which is very competitive
 - The FMS Dean's office suggested speaking to the VPR to match the funds of the Exchange Grant
 - Dean Berg might be able to get discretionary funds for the conference as well

Logo discussion (recap with Alex)

- Lauren is currently finishing the logo
 - There are a few edits left

Workshops and Outings discussion with Madelaine and Nick

- Nick met with Madelaine to discuss scheduling the workshops and outings around each other

Commented [LC1]: Alex - indoor mini golf is also an option, they need to let Alex know and she will contact her brother

- They sent out a poll last week to gauge ideas from the team
 - There were no extra ideas
 - People are on board with the photo competition idea
- They plan on having more outings on the first day of the conference when everyone arrives
- Alex suggested to not worry about scheduling all the workshops around each other because it might be tricky
 - Having multiple options is great for attendees to choose what they want to do
 - Would be good to have swag materials available for attendees
 - Brought back the idea of holding a mixed media contest with a silent auction to raise funds
 - Main suggestion: Pick 3 favourite ideas and we can expand upon those
- Madelaine spoke to Dr. Liette Vasseur about hosting a workshop
 - Dr. Vasseur agreed to the idea of hosting tours at the wineries she works with
 - Bench Brewery
 - They recycle all of their water
 - Would be good to tour their site
 - Madelaine and Nick will also be discussing an alternative option for those that are not drinking
 - Dr. Vasseur also suggested an option to do a workshop on writing and publishing in science (she is a journal editor)
- Alex asked which next steps are needed from the team to help with workshop/outing ideas
 - Madelaine explained they need feedback to help narrow down on ideas
 - one or two of the winery/brewery tours
 - something nature-based/outdoors
 - Nick will resend the form to figure out what people would be excited to do (most interesting workshops to keep)
 - They also want to incorporate other students that are not in ecology (e.g. Computer Sciences)
 - Alex explained there will probably be 20 people at a workshop, so the workshops can be a little niche
 - We can also change the workshops after people begin registering and we get an idea of what the general audience is
 - e.g. We could plan a coding workshop but only 1 computer science person registers, so we know the coding workshop might not be feasible

- Alternatively, we could realise that 20+ computer science students are registered which would mean we need more workshops related to their field
- Alex mentioned that we hope to open registration ASAP
 - Reem asked for an approximate cap on workshop registration
 - Alex explained it will depend on the workshop and what Nick and Madelaine decide

Keynote Update (recap with Alex)

- Harry will be sending out a form in Teams (in the Keynote channel)
 - He will start reaching out to potential speakers ASAP

Social Media Update with Matt

- No updates yet, they are awaiting the logo

Website Update with Rasa

- Rasa brought up a few questions for updating the website information:
 - Conference locations?
 - Kiyoko explained the main location can show Brock University for now, maybe show “including Pond Inlet” as well
 - We haven’t booked the rooms yet, so we will keep the information general for now
 - Hotel information and links?
 - Alex explained the information is available in the Accommodations channel on Teams and in the OE3C email (under Accommodations)
- New version of website includes the Brock red colour now
 - Alex mentioned the date on website needs to be changed to April 30 – May 2
 - Matt suggested using a duller red because the current red colour is a little intense which makes the text hard to read in some areas
 - Wylan suggested using a navy blue for the main page and making the accents Brock red instead
 - Follows Brock’s branding

- Nick suggested to make the “OE3C” title and dates stand out a bit more (e.g. add a text outline)
- Alex suggested for Rasa to give the team a deadline to send feedback on the website
 - Will be easier to track everyone’s ideas
 - Rasa explained that the end of the week would be a good deadline
 - Alex will put a link in the Files & Documents channel for everyone to submit ideas
- Rasa needs the acknowledgements for the footnotes of the webpage
 - Alex will send that information to Rasa

Budget discussion with Sarah

- Sarah met with Hannah Zang to get insights on their responsibilities
 - Hannah advised Sarah on being an internal budget keeper
 - Hannah helped Sarah recreate the budget template for OE3C
 - Current version will show net cost and revenue
 - Divided into sections to track expenses and funding
 - Broken down for each plenary speaker to track potential travel costs
 - Awards section – kept the same amounts from last year’s budget
 - Herpetology awards were sponsored last year, so those awards might not pertain to this year’s budget
 - Includes a profit/loss summary
 - Sarah needs feedback on the budget by the end of the week
 - Comments on the budget template spreadsheet
 - Alex will send the notification on Teams and important summaries will be sent via email
- Record keeping/expenses reports
 - Kiyoko has access to financial services
 - Sarah will report any expenses back to Kiyoko because there are forms that will need to be filled out
 - Alex asked how we might track general expenses for the subcommittee team leads (e.g. for any miscellaneous materials needed)
 - Sarah will create a form that people can submit, so she can collect the information and check the budget for approval (posted in Teams > Files and Documents)
 - Alex suggested to approve expenses based on whether we have funds available for that expense

Ads and Communications discussion

- Alex explained that we need a to-do list
 - Need to decide on a meeting time to start planning ads while waiting on the finalised logo from Lauren
 - Alex will send to out a when2meet
 - Cassia and Matt volunteered to be a part of the Ads & Communications meetings
- Alex offered to post blank Canva documents so people can collaborate on creating ads and we can utilise the paid Canva options through Alex's account

Fundraising discussion with Alex

- Alex needs to be notified first if anyone wants to send out emails to potential sponsors (to track who is contacting which sponsors)
 - Files and Documents channel contains all documents (under the Fundraising folder)
 - Contains PDF of fundraising package and letters for contacting sponsors
 - Fundraising channel contains a list of potential sponsors
 - People with personal connections to businesses will contact that sponsor directly
 - **Everyone should try contacting a minimum of two sponsors**
- Madelaine asked if there are different levels for sponsorships
 - Alex confirmed yes, the different tiers are present in the finalised package
 - Emails to sponsors will include the package attached as a PDF and the letter will be in the body of the email
 - When sending letters: the green text is meant to be edited in the sender's email (e.g. including our name)
 - There are 4 sponsorship tiers for corporations (bronze, silver, gold, and diamond)
 - Brock is a registered charity, so we are allowed to give out ta receipts for a monetary donation
 - Monetary donations get a tax receipt ONLY
 - Sponsors that align with the different tiers will get the appropriate benefits associated with their tier
 - Goal is to acquire "Gold" sponsorships
 - Alex is working on the letter to send to small businesses
 - Will make an infographic for how to use the fundraising package (step-by-step guide)
 - Will look into including a donation button on the OE3C website

Next Semester Meetings discussion

- Alex will post a when2meet so we can agree on another standing meeting time for next term
 - The team agreed to keep the biweekly meetings
 - Next meeting will be on Dec 15th (last meeting for the Fall term)

General Discussion

- Reem, Alex, Cassia, Sarah, and Kiyoko will be meeting with conference services
- Emails being sent on behalf of OE3C will also cc the OE3C email (oe3cofficial@gmail.com) and Lyly's email (lc15kl@brocku.ca) to track information
- Nick will send an updated poll for workshop/outing ideas
- Kiyoko submitted the Exchange Grant

Meeting adjourned at 11:14 AM.